

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 1 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

A Duck, A Dog, and a Deal

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ PREP

1. Please note that a few of the chapters will be skipped for the sake of time. You can encourage your student to read those chapters outside of lesson time.
2. You may want to read the introduction to get some more background knowledge about the book.

→ INTRO

This year, we are studying the history of the United States from 1800-1900. President Thomas Jefferson acquired a large amount of land west of the Mississippi for \$15 million through the Louisiana Purchase from France. He chose Meriwether Lewis to head an expedition to explore this area. Along with William Clark and a select group of men, a dog named Seaman joined the expedition. We learn about this dog in the journals of Lewis and Clark. For a long time, people thought the name of the dog was Scannon because it was hard to read the handwriting. Over the years, more information about Seaman has been found in the journals and other sources. That is what makes the study of history interesting—historians continue to find more evidence that adds to a fuller understanding of the past. The author wrote this story based on Lewis and Clark's journals, which were originally written with a quill pen!

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Map at the back of the book

At the beginning of the book, Lewis is in Pittsburgh and then needs to meet Clark before heading to Fort Wood, where they will spend the winter before they begin their expedition. Trace this route on the map. What rivers will he be traveling along to get to the camp?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 "The huge black" - "lift their spirits."

- One of the goals of the expedition was to look for the Northwest Passage. Many thought there would be a direct water route across the continent that led to the Pacific Ocean. It was believed that this waterway could open a direct trade route between North America and Asia. Lewis and Clark were to find out and let President Jefferson know. Do you know if there is a direct water route from the Atlantic to the Pacific? You can look at a map to find out.

→ VIEW

Look at the entry from Lewis's journal on p.9. What do you notice about the spelling? Spelling changes over time. You will notice different spellings in the other entries as well.

• EXTRA HELPING

If you have time, this is an interesting video that talks about the Louisiana Purchase and the reasons for the expedition.

∞ Video Link: Lewis and Clark Expedition Part 1

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

The Slave Auction, A Letter from a Schoolboy

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ INTRO

This book is about an Englishman named William Wilberforce (1759-1833) who was a member of Parliament, the lawmaking group in the government of Great Britain. The English had been part of the slave trade since 1662. In 1770, out of a total of one hundred thousand slaves a year from West Africa, British ships transported more than half. English

• IMPORTANT DATES

1759 Birth of William Wilberforce

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considered the slave trade inseparably linked with the wealth and national security of Great Britain. William worked tirelessly in Parliament to change the laws and abolish or get rid of the slave trade. As we learn about this remarkable man, we will also learn about what life was like in the late 1700s and early 1800s, what people were thinking or talking about, and how it was different from our lives today. We are mostly studying 1800-1900 this year, but this book begins a little earlier in 1759, when William was born.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of England

Find Hull, which is a coastal city in northern England. This is where William was born.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-17 "'No! No!' cried" - "on their journey."

- How would you describe the kind of family and lifestyle that William was born into?
- How are his life and opportunities different from the lives and opportunities of the slaves we were introduced to in the first chapter?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links: Birthplace of William Wilberforce & Portrait of William Wilberforce

WEEK 2 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

Getting Ready

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

You have met Meriwether Lewis, who was President Jefferson's personal secretary and an officer in the United States Army. Now we will meet William Clark, a retired officer who had served alongside Lewis in the Army. He will be the expedition's co-leader. Here is a replica of the keelboat that was built for this expedition. It was 55 feet long (almost the length of a bowling alley) with room for about 20 men to row and more space for supplies.

∞ Image Link: Replica of keelboat

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue Ch.2 p.11-18 "Along the banks" - "of a dog."

- Why might a dog be a good companion for the expedition?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Statue of Lewis and Clark

This statue on the Ohio River in Clarksville, Indiana, marks the meeting place where the two explorers met.

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

A Letter from a Schoolboy, To Cambridge

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

• EXTRA HELPING

This tour of Cambridge University shows the architecture and setting of the school. (5:00)

∞ Video Link: Cambridge University

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-26 "What's the coachman" - "law of gravity."

- What do you think it means that William's mom "was against anybody showing great enthusiasm" (p.21) in their spiritual life?
- How would you describe William when he was a college student?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photo of Cambridge University in the late 1800s.

WEEK 3 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

The Journey Begins

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

Today, you will read about the men who were chosen to be in the Corps (pronounced /kor/) of Discovery. What kind of skills do you think would be helpful for these men to have?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-27 "On November 20" - "a beautiful place."

→ VIEW

One of the goals of the expedition was to learn about plant and animal species and bring back samples. Here is a journal page that shows a drawing of a pheasant.

∞ Image Link: Journal Entry from Clark

• IMPORTANT DATES

1804 Lewis and Clark Expedition begins

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

To Cambridge, The Shrimp who Swelled into a Whale

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ INTRO

When someone says they want to enter public service for their career, what do they mean? It usually means they want to get involved in government. It is important to know a little about the government of the United Kingdom (England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland) since our book takes place in England. Parliament is the legislature or lawmaking group. The government leader, called the prime minister, is always a member of Parliament. This makes Britain different from the United States, which keeps Congress and the president in separate branches of government. Parliament is made up of two houses: the House of Lords and the House of Commons. You will read about William's entrance into public service.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.27-36 "William, despite his" - "guess," said Pitt."

- How do you think most people who knew William Wilberforce would have described him?
- What kind of advantages did he have that allowed him to be elected to Parliament?

→ VIEW

• DEFINITIONS

Chancellor of the Exchequer:

the chief financial minister and, as such, responsible for growing the UK economy.

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William Wilberforce and William Pitt spent time in college in the Strangers Gallery watching the proceedings of Parliament. This picture shows the Houses of Parliament on the River Thames in London, England, and the inside of the House of Commons, which was built in 1834. In this picture, the gallery for public viewing is on the second floor above the entrance.
∞ Image Links: Houses of Parliament in London & Strangers Gallery

WEEK 4 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4 *Sioux Territory*

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping chapter 4 for the sake of time. There will be a brief summary of it in the introduction.

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

1. We are skipping chapter 4, but one important incident to note is that Sergeant Charles Floyd developed serious stomach pains. Lewis gave him different medications that he had brought with him. However, Floyd died at the age of 22. They held a funeral service for him on a hill overlooking a river and named it "Sergeant Floyd's Bluff." Many people now think he had appendicitis.

2. Trace the route down the Missouri River to the place where Sergeant Floyd died.

📄 Map Resource: Map at the back of the book

3. Another goal of the expedition was to establish relations with Native Americans. In today's reading, Lewis and Clark will meet the Sioux who live in what is now South Dakota. This is what President Jefferson said to the explorers about the Sioux: "On that nation, we wish more particularly to make a friendly impression, because of their immense power, and because we learn they are very desirous of being on the most friendly terms with us." Let's see if they really do want to be on friendly terms with the Americans.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.37-45 "On the twenty-seventh" - "Clark climbed aboard."

→ VIEW

Look at the journal entry on p.46. How did Clark show leadership in that situation?

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4 *The Shrimp who Swelled into a Whale*

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The year is 1783, and William Wilberforce and his friend William Pitt are on a six-week holiday in France. Think about what is happening in America. The Revolutionary War is just ending. The French Revolution will take place 6 years later. William and William are going to meet Marie Antoinette, the queen of France, who was executed along with the king in 1793.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.36-42 "They were then" - "soul for eternity."

• EXTRA HELPING

This video gives an overview of the life of Marie Antoinette as well as some misconceptions about her.

∞ Video Link: The Story of Marie Antoinette

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- What does the title of the chapter mean?

→ VIEW

You can look through the different pictures that show the Palace of Versailles.

∞ Image Link: Palace of Versailles

WEEK 5 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

Sioux Territory; Winter Among the Indians

📄 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off last time?

→ INTRO

The Corps of Discovery will be meeting another tribe today, known as the Arikaras. Look at the map to see their location. What state did they live in?

∞ Map Link: Expedition Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.47-56 "As evening approached" - "understand each other."

→ VIEW

This is a picture of a reconstructed earth lodge that the Arikaras would have lived in.

∞ Image Link: Earth Lodge

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

Oh Happy Day

📄 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: The Strait of Dover

William is going on another holiday with his family, as well as with his friend Isaac Milner, to the French Riviera. How did people travel in those days? Trace their route across the Strait of Dover to Calais, France.

∞ Map Link: Rivers of Europe

Once they were in France, they took a carriage to Lyon and then put their carriages on a boat to sail down the Rhone River all the way to the Mediterranean Sea.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-50 "'Happy Birthday, Mr. Wilberforce!'" - "rang the doorbell."

- What kind of spiritual changes are happening with William?
- How do you think his time with his aunt and uncle when he was a child influenced him?

• DEFINITIONS

Theophilus Lindsay (a known minister during this time) left his ministry at the Church of England to start a Unitarian Church that did not believe the core doctrines of Christianity.

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WEEK 6 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

Winter Among the Indians

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, you will meet a teenage girl who joined the expedition. She has become quite famous in history, and there are 16 statues in her honor around the U.S. You will have to keep reading to see how she helps the Corps of Discovery.

∞ Image Link: Sakakawea (another spelling of Sacagawea) Statue in U.S. Capitol

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-66 "The Corps began" - "of my life."

→ VIEW

The Corps built Fort Mandan to stay in during the winter of 1804-1805.

∞ Image Link: Reconstructed Fort Mandan

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

The Truth about the Slave Trade

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

Note: We are skipping the chapter "Amazing Grace" for the sake of time. It is mostly about John Newton's conversion. We would encourage you to read it outside of class time.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

William was looking for a spiritual mentor and was encouraged to reach out to the minister and hymn writer John Newton. Have you heard of the hymn "Amazing Grace"? He was the author.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-71 "Good morning Mr Wilberforce!"-"on their hands."

- Why do you think William was troubled about whether he could still be in Parliament and be a Christian?
- Why would it be so hard for William to change the laws about the slave trade in England?

WEEK 7 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

Perils in Paradise

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: Today's reading is a little longer. If a teacher reads it aloud, it should take around 18 minutes.

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read last time.

→ INTRO

• DEFINITIONS

artery: any of the vessels that carry blood from the heart through the body (p.74)

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If you were exploring the wilderness of North Dakota, what animals might you be afraid of? We will read about some animals that brought peril or danger to the Corps of Discovery.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.67-77

→ VIEW

Read the journal excerpt on p.75. Seaman is mentioned in Lewis's journal!

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

Mr. Greatheart

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

Note: The reading is a little longer today.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How can laws help a society not engage in immoral or sinful behavior? How else can people help others who seem intent on living an immoral lifestyle? As we will read in this chapter, Wilberforce used his influence for good and not only fought against the slave trade but also strived to make England a better place for all people to live.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-82 "'There are too'"-"his nation's conscience."

- Why do you think William persevered through the obstacles and discouragement?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Statue of William Wilberforce

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to skip the last paragraph on p.82 that talks about the immoral behavior of some teenagers.

• DEFINITIONS

dissolute: lacking restraint, marked by indulgence

WEEK 8 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

Searching for the Shoshone

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping chapter 8 for the sake of time. Feel free to have your student read it on their own.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

1. We are skipping chapter 8. In that chapter, Seaman is back to normal and chases a 2000-pound buffalo through the campsite. The Corps of Discovery came to a fork in the Missouri River and needed to decide which way to go. They decided to take the southern river and came across many waterfalls that Lewis described as "the grandest sight I ever beheld." The water was falling over a cliff more than 80 feet high. They would have to portage (carry their boats overland) around the waterfalls. To lighten their load, they stored some of their supplies in a cache or hiding place in the ground that they would get on their way back.
2. Find the Great Falls on the map. Now go along the route until you get to Three Forks. Continue on the route until you find where the Shoshone lived. The Corps of Discovery needed to find these people because they had something very valuable that the explorers needed.

∞ Map Link: Map of Expedition

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.89-97 "Seaman splashed into" - "horses to trade!"

→ VIEW

This picture shows the headwaters (original source) of the Missouri River in Montana. This is the point where the three forks—the Jefferson, Gallatin, and Madison rivers—join as one, the great Missouri River.
∞ Image Link: Image of Three Forks

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

The Duel

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

If people can't agree on important matters, what might they do to settle their disagreements? In the past, dueling was a common way to settle disputes around the world and in America. A duel is a combat between persons armed with lethal weapons—usually swords or guns—that is held according to prearranged rules to settle a quarrel or a point of honor. You will learn how that dangerous practice was finally outlawed in England.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-90 "Get out of it"—"new bride, Barbara."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Holy Trinity Church in Clapham, England
This is the church where the "Clapham Saints" worshipped together and encouraged each other to do good for their society.

• DEFINITIONS

sedition: describes the action of saying, writing, or doing something that encourages people to disobey their government (p.85 talks about Seditious Meetings Bill)

WEEK 9 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

Searching for the Shoshone; Ocean in View! Oh, the Joy!

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

The reading will be broken up into two sections because we are skipping chapter 10. Do you remember what tribe Sacagawea is from? (Shoshone) When she was about 12 years old, she was captured by an enemy tribe, the Hidatsa, and later given to the French-Canadian trader, Charbonneau, who was living among the Hidatsa, as one of his wives. It had been about 5 years since she had seen her people.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Finish Ch.9 p.97-101 "The Indians crowded" - "the other explorers."
2. Chapter 10 talks about a very trying time for everyone as they entered the Rocky Mountains. The path was steep, there was little food, and it was cold and wet. After hiking more than 150 miles in eleven days, they made it over the Rocky Mountains. The men finally got some food from the Nez Perce Indians, but after not eating much for 11 days and then gorging on dried fish and berries, the men felt sick.
3. Begin Ch.11 p.115-119 "I don't know" - "eating dog meat."

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WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

The Duel, A Night of Nights

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The year is now 1805. The French Revolution that threw down the monarchy was over. A man named Napoleon Bonaparte had risen to power in France. To the troops he commanded in battle, Napoleon was known fondly as the "Little Corporal." To the monarchs and kings whose thrones he overthrew, he was "that Corsican ogre." Some believed him to be a great reformer. Others thought him a monster. Friend and foe alike, however, could agree on one fact: "Napoleon I, emperor of France and for 16 years master of most of Europe, was one of the greatest military geniuses of all time" (from Britannica Kids). We will read about his conflicts with England.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-100 "One morning, early," - "seen at Portsmouth."

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Battle of Trafalgar

Watch this video that discusses a painting about the Battle of Trafalgar.

WEEK 10 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10

Ocean in View! Oh, the Joy!

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Eighty percent of the Corps of Discovery's round-trip journey was by water. Today, you will read about more of their journey over the rivers. They will have to decide whether they will portage their canoes or go through the rapids. What would you do? Take a look at this miniature replica of the dugout canoe that they rode in. Generally, the dugouts were about thirty feet long and up to three feet wide, and they held supplies and four to six men, who probably knelt to keep the center of gravity low and prevent tipping. Empty, each canoe may have weighed as much as a ton.

∞ Image Link: Dugout canoe

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Expedition

After they pass the Nez Perce, what two rivers will they come across?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.119-128 "By the time" - "O! the joy."

• DEFINITIONS

spawned: to produce or lay eggs in water (p.121)

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10

A Night of Nights, Free at Last

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The practice of suttee in India is mentioned on p.107. You may want to think of how you will address that issue with your students. It was a Hindu practice that displayed womanly devotion.

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→ INTRO

It has been almost 20 years since William first proposed his bill to abolish the slave trade in the British Empire. Let's see if he finally has enough votes to pass during a session of Parliament on the evening of February 23, 1807.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.100-108 "The Napoleonic Wars"- "open the door."

- Why do you think he finally got enough votes?

Hindus also believed in reincarnation and that what you do on earth gives you better status when you are reincarnated.

• DEFINITIONS

euphoria: a feeling of well-being or excitement (p.103)

• IMPORTANT DATES

1807 The Slave Trade Act was passed

WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11

A Soggy Winter

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Do you remember what Captain Clark said at the end of the last chapter? "Ocean in view! O joy." They were actually in the Columbia River Estuary. Look at this aerial image of the Columbia River Estuary. Do you think it has fresh water or salt water? An estuary is a partially enclosed body of water where fresh water from rivers and streams mixes with salt water from the ocean. The resulting water is called brackish.

∞ Image Link: Aerial image of Columbia River Estuary

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.129-137 "The next day" - "but known distance."

Note: The rest of the chapter will not be assigned. You may want students to read it during exam week.

- Do you think a group vote is a good way to make a decision? Why or why not?
- Now the crew can head back home. What do you think they were looking forward to when they got back home?

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11

The Death of Wilberforce

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.108-114 "But what of his"- "us, pointing upward."

- What stood out to you about the life of William Wilberforce?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Memorial at Westminster Abbey

You can look at William's memorial in Westminster Abbey and read the inscription on the statue.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1833 Death of William Wilberforce

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WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Seaman: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark	
WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter	

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Term 2

WEEK 1 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

Blackfeet and Bad Luck

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

PREP: We are skipping chapter 13 for the sake of time. Students can always read it outside of lesson time.

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off?

→ INTRO

In chapter 13, the Corps of Discovery started heading home, but since it was early spring, the animals were not as plentiful. They also had to wait for the snow to melt before they could cross the Rocky Mountains. They were told about a shortcut that could take 80 miles off their homebound journey.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Begin Ch.14 p.159-167 "Seaman paced through" - "had led his party."

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

Hunger

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

When you think of Ireland, what comes to mind? Perhaps the story of St. Patrick. Ireland is often called the Emerald Isle because of its lush greenery. It is considered an enchanting place to visit.

∞ Image Link: The Cliffs of Moher

However, in the 1840s, tragedy struck Ireland that changed it forever. There was a terrible famine, and many people either died or left the country to go to America. Today, one-sixth of US citizens (43 million) identify their national background as Irish. What was it like to live in Ireland at this time? This book is a fictional account of an Irish family during that time and what they did to survive. It is hard to read about such a sad time in history and all the suffering that happened, but we also read about those who persevered and had hope for a brighter future. The author is from Ireland and has sequels to this book if you want to read more. Let's first learn about the geography of Ireland.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas p.82-83 & ∞ Map Link: Ireland

1. In what continent is Ireland located?
2. What large ocean lies west of Ireland?
3. Which country is directly east of Ireland across the Irish Sea?
4. What sea lies between them?
5. What is the capital city of Ireland?
6. Now look at the link for the map of Ireland to answer the rest of the questions. Find Cork in the southern part of Ireland. The characters in this story live in Duneen, which lies in the region of Cork.
7. What river runs through Cork?
8. What mountain range runs along parts of Ireland's east coast?
9. What is the longest river in Ireland?
10. Which part of Ireland is generally more mountainous—the east or the west?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. A Simple History of the Great Famine p.121-123

• EXTRA HELPING

This is a good overview about the famine that sets the context for the book.

∞ Video Link: Irish Potato Famine

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Term 2

2. Ch.1

- What do you think about the different reactions from the men and women that the author mentions on p.2—"the men cursed and the women prayed to God to save them"?

→ VIEW

These are photographs of traditional farmhouses or cottages in Ireland in the 1800s.

∞ Image Links: Traditional Cottages & Inside of Cottages

WEEK 2 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

End of the Expedition

📖 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ NOTE

This reading is longer in order to finish the book. You may have to finish it outside of lesson time.

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.167-179 "On August 11" - "tail wagging eagerly."

- Do you remember the 3 main goals of the expedition (find a northwest passage, establish relationships with Native Americans, and learn about new plants and animals)? Did they accomplish their goals? (There was no direct water route to the west, but the other goals were accomplished.)
- How might the expedition have been different without Seaman?

→ VIEW

This statue can be found outside the Lewis and Clark Interpretative Center in Sioux City, Iowa.

∞ Image Link: Statue of Lewis, Clark & Seaman

• IMPORTANT DATES

1806 Lewis and Clark Expedition ends when they reach St.Louis

- ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

Under the Hawthorn Tree, Nothing to Eat

📖 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

During this time in Ireland, people used turf to heat their homes and cook their food. Turf, also known as peat, was harvested from a bog, which is a kind of wetland. Turf or peat is dead plant matter that hardens and turns into coal. People would have to go to the bog to cut turf by hand and dry it in the sun before it could be used for fuel. This process will be mentioned in the chapter.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Peat stocks

This picture shows the stocks of peat that were being sliced and taken from the bog.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-20 "The breeze continued."-"her brave brother."

★ TEACHER NOTE

p.10 talks about the death of their baby sister.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- How would you describe the religious beliefs of the family?
- Why do you think the children didn't show hospitality to the woman and her son?

WEEK 3 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

The Mysterious Mr. Lincoln; A Backwoods Boy

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ INTRO

What do you know about Abraham Lincoln? There are more books written about Lincoln than any other American. This book is called a photobiography. How might photos help us understand a person from the past instead of just words? How might photos not give us a complete picture of the past?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-10 "Abraham Lincoln wasn't" - "beneath the roof."

- What are some initial impressions you have about Lincoln so far?
- Why do you think so many people didn't learn to read and write back then?

• DEFINITIONS

reticent: inclined to be silent or uncommunicative in speech (p.2)

yarns: stories (p.4)

emancipator: someone who frees others from bondage (p.5)

• IMPORTANT DATES

1809 Abraham Lincoln was born

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

Nothing to Eat, On Their Own

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Here is a little more background information about the potato disease or blight. "Almost overnight, healthy green fields of potatoes turned black. Prior to the blight, many Irish families relied on potatoes as their primary food source. The average man ate 14 pounds of potatoes a day. Mixed with buttermilk, potatoes provided a nutritious diet for hard-working laborers. Ireland was unprepared for the recurring failure of the potato crop in the years 1845–1849. As it turned out, the crop failure was due to a fungus that was unknown at the time, which is now believed to have been *Phytophthora infestans*. Approximately 40 percent of the crop was lost in 1845; however, it did not lead to famine, as surplus from the previous year sustained the population along with some government relief. The next year's harvest was expected to be healthy and plentiful. However, in 1846, the blight returned to the potato crop in Ireland, and relief from the government in England was slow and inadequate. Soon disease and death spread across the country" (From Great Hunger Museum).

→ VIEW

The potato plant grows underground. Potatoes are grown by planting seed potatoes—sprouted chunks of old potatoes—which form multiple new tubers underground, typically five to six per seed piece. Usually after 90–135 days, when the plant's foliage has browned and fully died back, it is ready to be picked.

∞ Image Link: Potato Plant

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-30 "The sky had" - "of the blankets."

- How would you have answered Eily when she said, "Sometimes I wonder does God even know what is happening down here—his world is so vast and big?"

• DEFINITIONS

draper shop: a dealer in cloth and sometimes also in clothing and dry goods (p.24)

ghile: a Gaelic expression of endearment, such as my darling (p.23)

stór: a Gaelic expression that means my treasure (p.24)

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

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Term 2

- Did you notice some of the unfamiliar words in this chapter—a ghile (p.23) and a stór (p.24)? Those words come from the Irish language, also known as Gaelic or Gaelige. The origins of the Irish language can be traced back to the 4th century AD, when it evolved from a common Celtic language spoken by the ancient Celts who lived in Ireland. When England took control of Ireland, the English language became more common than Gaelic, although some words have carried over.

WEEK 4 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

A Backwoods Boy

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography, US Atlas

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you remember about Lincoln so far.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: US Atlas

1. p.10-11 Lincoln lived in Indiana by the Ohio River and worked as a ferryman's helper. Find that on the map.
2. Then he was hired to take someone on a flatboat voyage on the Mississippi River. Trace the route from the Ohio River to the Mississippi River and follow it until it ends.
3. p.14-15 What city does the Mississippi River flow through before reaching the Gulf?

→ INTRO

Do you have any ideas about how children on the frontier got their schooling? We will read about the kind of schooling Lincoln had.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.10-19 "Soon after the" - "were fast friends."

- What do you think about the way Lincoln got his education?
- How would you describe Lincoln's work ethic? Work ethic is a set of values centered on the importance of doing work, as seen through one's desire or determination to work hard.

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

On Their Own, The Road to the Workhouse

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Until about 1900, the greater part of the land in Ireland (97% in 1870) was owned by landlords who rented it out to tenant farmers rather than cultivating it themselves. The tenant farmers would grow crops and raise animals on the land and pay the landlord with either money or crops. Many of the landlords lived in England and had an overseer to manage everyday affairs.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-41 "All the next" - "to keep hidden."

- What do you think of their decision not to go to the workhouses and try to find their aunts? What are the risks?

• DEFINITIONS

boreen: a narrow country lane (p.35)

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 5 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

A Backwoods Boy; Law and Politics

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you remember about Lincoln so far.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Places where Lincoln lived

1. Near what town was Lincoln born in Kentucky?
2. Where in Indiana did they move when he was a boy?
3. When he was 21, they set off for what town in Illinois?
4. At 22, he then moved away from his family to work at a general store in what town?
5. When Lincoln becomes a lawyer and is elected to a second term for the state legislature, he moves to the state capital of Illinois. What is the name of that city?

→ INTRO

If you wanted to learn something new and couldn't ask an adult to teach you, how would you go about doing that? There were a lot of things that Lincoln didn't know about, but that didn't stop him from learning all about them. We will read more about the topics he studied in today's reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-28 "Lincoln also found" - "just good friends."

- What are your impressions now about Lincoln?
- How has he changed from the boy who lived in the backwoods to the lawyer and state representative? How has he not changed?

• DEFINITIONS

melancholy: a sad mood or feeling (p.27)

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

The Road to the Workhouse, Follow the River

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Workhouses were built by the government before the famine as places of refuge for those who were unable to support themselves, often due to extreme poverty. A typical day inside a workhouse was to rise at 6 am, breakfast at 6.30 am, work until 12 noon, lunch break, and then work until 6 pm. Supper was served at 7 pm, with lights out at 8 pm. Husbands, wives, and children were separated as they entered the workhouse and could be punished if they attempted to speak to each other. An inmate's only possessions were his/her uniform, mattress, and blanket. Once a week, the inmates bathed, and the men shaved. The conditions were unsanitary, and the conditions were harsh because they didn't want people to go to the workhouses unless it was the last resort. However, during the famine, more and more people had no other choice.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-51 "Eily, Eily"-"happened to them."

- What do you think Mary Kate meant by the advice she gave to the children, "Let nature be your friend and help." (p.45)

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of a workhouse

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 6 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

Law and Politics

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

Do you know the two major political parties in the US? (Republican and Democrat) During this time, the Democrats and the Whigs were the two major parties, although in 1854, most northern Whigs joined the newly formed Republican Party. That was the party of Lincoln. The Whigs used the same name as the English political party that opposed absolute monarchy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-37 "While Lincoln was" - "knees beside him."

- No one's life is perfect, and Lincoln had his share of hardships and disappointments in his personal life and in his political career. How does he seem to handle these pressures?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL IF THERE IS TIME)

This chapter talked about Lincoln's opposition to the Mexican War. This short video is helpful in explaining the war and how America expanded at that time.

∞ Video Link: How the Mexican-American War changed the US forever

• DEFINITIONS

temperamental: marked by excessive sensitivity and impulsive mood changes (p.28)

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

Follow the River, The Soup Kitchen

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

History is complicated, and it is hard to simplify all the conflict that existed between Protestant England and Catholic Ireland at the time. The Acts of Union in 1800 that created the United Kingdom had declared that Ireland, a predominantly Catholic country, would be directly under British rule. Many farms in Ireland were owned by English absentee landlords. The Irish were, in effect, second-class citizens in their own country. This background will help you understand some of the hardships in this book and why England didn't provide as much help as it should have.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-61 "By next morning"-"yet another good-bye."

- Did you notice what the old man said to them? He told them to leave as the heathens might try to convert them (p.59). And they were mentioned as strange religious folk on p.57. Many soup kitchens were set up by Protestant groups, and since most Irish people were Catholic, the man was warning the children. The author is showing the tension that existed in Ireland between the Irish Catholics and English Protestants.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 7 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

Half Slave and Half Free

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-48 "Lincoln was at" - "way of life."

- How would you describe Lincoln as a family man?
- What characteristics of Lincoln made him a good lawyer?

• DEFINITIONS

propriety: conformity to what is socially acceptable in conduct or speech, proper (p.41)

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

Beside the Lake, At the Harbor

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

Note: We are skipping Ch.8 for the sake of time and the graphic descriptions of starvation and death.

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

You may be wondering why the Irish were so dependent on the potato and why they didn't have other crops. "Potatoes are not native to Ireland but likely originated in the Andes Mountains of Peru, South America. In the early 1500s, Spanish conquerors found the Incas growing the vegetable, which the Spanish called patata. They were taken back to Europe and eventually reached England, where the name changed to potato. About 1590, potatoes were introduced to Ireland, where farmers quickly discovered they thrived in their country's cool, moist soil with very little labor. An acre of fertilized potato field could yield up to 12 tons of potatoes, enough to feed a family of six for a year, with leftovers going to the family's animals. By the 1800s, the potato had become the staple crop in the poorest regions. More than three million Irish peasants subsisted solely on the vegetable, which is rich in protein, carbohydrates, minerals, and vitamins such as riboflavin, niacin, and Vitamin C. Irish peasants were actually healthier than peasants in England or Europe, where bread, far less nutritious, was the staple food" (from historyplace.com). Although the potato crop failed, some farmers in Ireland were still growing wheat, oats, barley, and other crops that were exported to England. That is why many Irish people blamed England for not helping them as much as they could have. You will read more about that in today's reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-part of Ch.10

p.73-80 "The following day"-"Let's leave it."

- How have the children matured and changed since leaving their house?

WEEK 8 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

Half Slave and Half Free

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ NOTE

Some of the concepts discussed in this chapter might be a little advanced for some students. Obviously, they don't need to understand every aspect of the debates between Lincoln and Douglas. It is important to



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understand the main idea they were debating, which is mentioned in the introduction below, and then have some understanding of the differing views. You can stop often to have them narrate and even write some of the arguments on a whiteboard, showing the different sides. The debates will also be part of the next lesson.

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of US in 1854

1. Look at the map key. What does orange mean? What does green mean?
2. Where are most of the states that allow slavery located? Why do you think that is the case?

→ INTRO

Here is the issue that the government was discussing: Would each new state enter as a free state or a slave state? A new act passed by Congress (the Kansas-Nebraska Act) said that the people in each new state would decide what to do about slavery. That means that slavery might continue to spread. Lincoln could sit back no longer. He now felt compelled to do what he could to oppose the spread of slavery. He went back into politics to win a Senate seat and engaged in seven public debates with a man named Stephen Douglas. These events were like a modern-day sporting event and were attended by thousands of people.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.50-59 "The issue came" - "into the air."

- What does it say about the character of Lincoln that he was willing to go back into politics and to argue so strongly against slavery?

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

At the Harbor, Traveling by Night

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

While many people stayed in Ireland hoping for an end to the famine, millions of people emigrated (to leave one's country to live elsewhere) to other places. Between 1845 and 1855, nearly 2 million people emigrated from Ireland to America and Australia, and another 750,000 to Britain. The Poor Law Extension Act, which made landlords responsible for the maintenance of their own poor, urged the landlords to pay for their tenants to leave the country. However, emigrating was not an easy solution. Ships were overcrowded, and many people died before reaching their new home. Disease spread quickly on board because people were packed in so close together. These ships became known as "coffin ships" because so many people died aboard them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.80-88 "Eily and Peggy"-"by day again."

- On p.84 the author says that Eily realizes just how young Peggy is and how brave she is. How do you think this kind of journey will change the children's understanding of themselves and the world around them?

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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WEEK 9 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

Half Slave and Half Free; Emancipation

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time? Do you remember some of the differences between Lincoln and Douglas?

→ INTRO

Now you will read about the debates that were all held in different small towns in Illinois in the summer of 1858. What do you think makes someone a good debater? Then you will see how those debates brought Lincoln into the spotlight.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.59-68 "The give and take" - "compromise had failed."

- What do you think were Lincoln's strongest points of argument against Douglas?
- When Lincoln took his oath of office, what kind of country was he leading?

• DEFINITIONS

popular sovereignty: the theory that government is created by and subject to the will of the people. In this case, the people could vote on whether a state should be free or allow slavery. (p.59)

secede: to separate from a nation or state and become independent (p.65)

howitzer: a large gun that is used to fire shells high into the air for a short distance (p.67)

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

Peggy's Fever, Michael's Desperate Search

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

PREP: You may want to read the PDF titled "How Can God Be Good and Allow Evil and Suffering?" so you can discuss these issues with your student as you see fit. This issue is addressed by one of the characters at the end of today's reading.

∞ PDF Link: How Can God Be Good and Allow Evil and Suffering? (from corechristianity.com)

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.89-97 "Eily could not"-"was a monster."

- Does that last sentence bother you? What would you say to Michael?

WEEK 10 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22

Emancipation

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

The worst came true—the nation was in a civil war. A civil war is when citizens of the same country fight each other. More people died in the Civil War than in any other war that America has been a part of. Most people thought the war would end quickly. The North had a larger population, factories to produce ammunition and guns, and better means of transportation. However, the South had more military leaders and military talent. The war lasted 4 long years.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-79 "He traveled east" - "on Tad's bed."

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→ VIEW (OPTIONAL IF YOU HAVE TIME)

This 4-minute video does a good job of explaining why the "Union" was so important to the people and why it was worth fighting for. NOTE: At around 2:12, there is an illustration of a scantily clad woman on the battlefield representing Lady Liberty.

∞ Video Link: What was the Union?

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22

Michael's Desperate Search, The Cow, Castletaggart

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

This tragedy impacted the population of Ireland and the population of Irish immigrants in America. Between the famine and people emigrating to other places, you can see the decrease in population and also how it continued after the famine. The population never again reached the size it was before the famine.

(4 years before famine) 1841—8 million

(During famine) 1851—6 million

(After famine) 1871—4 million

2017—4.75 million

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.97-109 "Eily kept watching"—"them some relief."

WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23

This Dreadful War

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

PREP: There is one more week of this book in Term 3, which tells about Lincoln's assassination. We are skipping most of chapter 6, which is about the war, for the sake of time and due to the graphic details in the chapter. You may want to read parts of it with your student during exam week. Otherwise, there will be a couple of paragraphs read in lesson 25 before we finish the book. There is also an article you can read or listen to that talks about some of the major battles of the war.

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

Just when Lincoln was facing such difficulty as the President during the Civil War, he would face a personal tragedy as well. But even in his grief, Lincoln had to press on and make big decisions. What should leaders consider before making important choices?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.80-91 "Lincoln took the"—"for this act."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview the photo on p.88 and decide how you want to handle that with sensitive children.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Important Battles of the Civil War

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23

Castletaggart, Journey's End

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

• DEFINITIONS

demesne: the land attached to an estate (p.107)

Term 2	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.109-119 "A priest passed"-the hawthorn tree. • What are some characteristics you would use to describe the children? • What did you learn about the Irish Famine from this historical novel that you wouldn't have learned if you just read about it in a non-fiction book? → VIEW Did you notice all the times the hawthorn tree was mentioned, including the title of the book? Watch this video to see why hawthorn trees are significant to Irish folklore. ∞ Video Link: Hawthorn Trees (just watch 1:54-4:35)	
WEEK 12  25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Lincoln: A Photobiography	
WEEK 12  25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Under the Hawthorn Tree	

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Who Is Dead in the White House?

Materials: Lincoln: A Photobiography

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off in this book?

→ INTRO

We are skipping most of chapter 6 about the battles of the war. We will read the last couple of pages of the chapter that talk about Lincoln's reelection and the end of the war. The second part of today's reading discusses the tragic end of Lincoln's life.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.112-130 "Union victories had" - "does not falter."

- What lessons can modern readers learn from Lincoln's life?
- Why do you think more books are written about Lincoln than any other American?

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Aliens Arrive

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→ INTRO

This is a non-fiction book that tells the story of how U.S. Navy ships headed by Commodore Matthew Perry sailed to Japan in 1853 to bring a letter from President Fillmore asking Japan to open its ports to trading with the U.S. Other attempts had been tried before but were unsuccessful. Due to policies in Japan, it had remained isolated from most other countries for hundreds of years. Imagine you are living in your small fishing village of Shimoda and have never met anyone from another country. You see four huge ships approaching. That is what it was like for the people on that day in July 8, 1853. Let's first learn about the geography of Japan.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas p.30-31, 92-93

1. On which continent is Japan found?
2. How would you get from the U.S. to Japan in a ship if you were going to leave from the East Coast?
3. Which countries are closest to Japan?
4. Is Japan north or south of the equator?
5. What is the capital of Japan?
6. Turn to p.92-93. How many main islands is Japan made up of? Name them. There are also nearly 4,000 smaller islands!
7. Which island is the largest?
8. What bodies of water surround Japan?
9. What physical features cover much of Japan?
10. Why might Japan's island location have helped protect it from invasions?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-20 "If monsters had"-"ship to leave."

- Why do you think the title of the first chapter is "Aliens Arrive"?
- Why might they think American ships are not coming on friendly terms?

→ VIEW

• DEFINITIONS

turmoil: a state or condition of extreme confusion (p.14)

inept: lacking qualities (as knowledge, skill, or ability) required to do a job (p.15)

• EXTRA HELPING

The Japanese had never seen a steamship. If you are interested in learning more about steamships, watch this video.

∞ **Video Link:** The Story of Steamships (2:55-5:00)

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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∞ Image Links: Japanese Society & Chart of Feudal System

1. Japan was still based on a feudal society, which means society was divided into strict social classes where everyone had a specific role that they had to follow. Read the description of Japanese society and look at the chart that shows the feudal system and who has the most power and the least power.

2. Look at the illustrations at the beginning of the book and in Ch.1. Then read about the illustrations on p.138. Most of the illustrations from that time period come from either Japanese artists or American artists who were part of the expedition.

WEEK 2 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

Declaration of Independence; Slavery

📖 Materials: Heart and Soul

→ INTRO

This book tells about what life was like for African Americans during this time period, who were brought to the United States against their will to become slaves. The first chapter will go back to the time during the Revolutionary War when America was fighting for its independence from Britain. It is told in the voice of a grandmother telling her grandchild the story of the trials and courage of African Americans through the centuries.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2 p.9-21

- Why was it impossible for slaves to fight back against those who captured them or against their masters?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: US Capitol Building

∞ Image Link: Inside the Rotunda

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

The Black Ships of Evil Men, His High and Mighty Mysteriousness

📖 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The four American ships full of 560 men of the U.S. Navy have arrived off the coast of Japan, and now we will find out how the Japanese will respond. What do you think they will do?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-29 "As a precaution"- "a lower rank."

- Why do you think Commodore Perry stood firm on his decision not to sail to the port in Nagasaki or meet with lower officials? (Interesting note: It was said that Perry realized that previous failures had resulted from insufficient show of strength and ignorance of Japanese character, two mistakes he would never make.)
- What are some of the differences you notice so far between the Americans and the Japanese?

• DEFINITIONS

moored: anchored (p.20)

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

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WEEK 3 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Abolition; Lincoln's War

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.23-37

- Why was learning to read and write such a powerful weapon and, therefore, illegal for slaves?
- Is there anything you read in this retelling of the Civil War that gave a different perspective than what you remember from Lincoln's biography?

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Landing on Sacred Soil

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.4 p.30-36

- What stood out to you about the meeting?

2. Read the letter from President Fillmore that is found in Appendix A, p.123-124.

- Do you think the letter was persuasive? What do you think about the reasons he gave for opening trade?

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustration on p.32-33 and the details you remember from the reading.

• DEFINITIONS

cutlass: a short curving sword formerly used by sailors on warships (p.31)

pikemen: soldiers with heavy spears with a very long shaft (p.31)

anteroom: a small outer room that leads to another room and that is often used as a waiting room (p.34)

capacious: wide or huge (p.36)

abrogate: to put an end to by formal action (p.124)

WEEK 4 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

Reconstruction; Cowboys and Indians

Materials: Heart and Soul

→ INTRO

The slaves were set free, but now what would they do and where would they live? What kind of issues would need to be addressed now that the war is over?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-6 p.39-51

- What new opportunities did African Americans have after the war, and in what ways was it still very hard?

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

The Dutch Island Prison, Foreigners Forbidden

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to skip the last sentence on p.39 that tells about the actions of the Dutchmen before the Shoguns.



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The only Western country that had been allowed to trade with Japan was the Netherlands, which began trade in 1608. The Dutch traders were confined to an artificial island and had many rules to follow. You will read about that in this chapter. Then the next chapter will explain why the Japanese were cut off from the rest of the world and how it had not always been that way.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Japan

Find Nagasaki on the western side of Japan. The tiny island of Deshima was connected by bridge to Nagasaki.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.5 p.37-40

- Why do you think the Dutch put up with all those rules and requirements in order to have a trading station?

2. Ch.6 p.41-43

- Why do you think the Japanese mistrusted foreigners?

→ VIEW

This illustration from Phillip von Siebold's book shows Deshima, the artificial island where the Dutch traders lived.

∞ Image Link: Illustration of Deshima.

WEEK 5 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

Frontier Photographers; Going West

📄 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

How do historians write books about the past? They look at primary sources such as letters, documents, and photographs from the time period to try to understand what life was like. In this book, you will be able to see actual photographs from the 1800s to learn about what life was like for children who moved with their families to the western part of the United States. If you could ask children from back then any questions about their lives, what might you ask them?

→ LOCATE

Trace the route of the Oregon Trail. Where does it begin? In today's reading, you will read about a family that has made it to the North Platte River, which is now part of current-day Wyoming. Find that on the map.

∞ Map Link: Map of Oregon Trail

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-18 "On May 19" - "a foreign land."

- Do you think the photographs captured the personality of the people since they had to stand still and not move at all (or the picture would be blurred)?

→ VIEW

Take time to look at the photographs. What do you think it would be like traveling in the covered wagons?

• IMPORTANT DATES

1841 First pioneers set out from Missouri to head west

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this video to learn more about the first transcontinental railroad mentioned on p.17.

∞ Video Link: Transcontinental Railroad

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

The Great Peace

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please note the reference to ritual suicide on p.48.

• DEFINITIONS

vassal: a person who received protection and land from a lord in

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

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Term 3

→ INTRO

In this chapter, you will learn more about the Japanese feudal system, where everyone was born into a specific social class. You may want to write the names of the classes on a whiteboard or piece of paper as you read about them and put symbols or words that represent their roles and obligations.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.44-53

- What do you think the basis was for all the specific rules they had?
- How do you determine what rules a society should have and what rules take away personal freedom?

return for loyalty and service (p.47)

saki: a Japanese alcoholic drink that is made from rice (p.52)

stratified: divided into social classes (p.53)

WEEK 6 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30

Going West; Settling Down

📄 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

When people talk about the Oregon Trail, they are mostly referring to a pair of wheel ruts cutting across the prairie grass. Follow the trail on p.19. What rivers and geographical features do you see along the Oregon Trail?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-30 "Their journey started" - "50,000 by 1855."

- What do you think would be the hardest part about traveling out west?
- Why do you think people were so determined to do it despite the hardships?

→ VIEW

1. Look at the log cabin on p.27. How did they use natural resources for all aspects of the cabin, inside and out?
2. (Optional) Watch this short video about the Gold Rush in California. (Can stop at 1:40)
∞ Video Link: The Gold Rush

• DEFINITIONS

ford: to cross (a body of water) by walking through it (p.18)

bureau: dresser (p.21)

cholera: a serious disease that causes severe vomiting and diarrhea and that often results in death (p.23)

typhoid: a serious disease that is passed from one person to another in dirty food or water (p.23)

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this video to learn more about log cabins.

∞ Video Link: Pioneer Life in a Log Cabin

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30

Clouds Over the Land of the Rising Sun, The Black Ships Return

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Student World Atlas, p.93
Find Hong Kong. (southeastern China) Commodore Perry and his men went to Hong Kong while they waited for the Japanese leaders to make their decision.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.8 p.54-59
- What do you think about some of the American customs that Manjiro

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the first paragraph on p.63 that talks about women, liquor, and minstrel shows.

• DEFINITIONS

armaments: weapons (p.56)

quandary: a situation in which you are confused about what to do (p.57)

monotony: a lack of change that makes something boring (p.65)

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

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Term 3

found strange?

2. Begin Ch.9 p.63-65 "Commodore Perry had"- "to read documents."

WEEK 7 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31

Settling Down

 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ RECAP

Briefly talk about the previous reading.

→ INTRO

You read about the log cabins that were built by the pioneers. What kind of houses do you think families built if they lived in the prairies, where there were not a lot of trees? You will read about the kinds of houses they built and see if you would like that kind of house.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-40 "So far, the" - "from their own."

- What do you think about the soddies? Would you want to live in one?
- How have homes changed since these early days?

→ VIEW

Look at the picture on p.35. List any observations you have about Main Street of Granite, Oklahoma. How is it different from your town?

• DEFINITIONS

cheesecloth: a thin, gauzy cotton fabric with a loose weave. It was first used in cheesemaking but has many other kitchen functions. (p.33)

• IMPORTANT DATES

1862 Congress passes the Homestead Act

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31

The Black Ships Return, The Treaty House

 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Finish Ch.9 p.65-68 "During the long"-"safe from harm."
2. Ch.10 p.69-77

• Perry didn't think the Japanese valued human life because of their treatment of the American sailors and some of the Japanese customs. What would it look like if a society valued human life?

3. If time permits, you can read the letter to the President in Appendix B, p.125-126.

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustrations on p.70-73 and the details you remember from the reading.

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is mention of ritual suicides on p.76 in the last two paragraphs.

• DEFINITIONS

retainers: servants (p.69)

WEEK 8 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32

The American Indians

 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ RECAP

Briefly talk about the previous reading.

→ INTRO

The American West was hardly an empty wilderness. Hundreds of thousands of Indians still lived west of the Mississippi River at this time. We will learn what life was like for Native Americans and their children at that time.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-57 "The Oregon Trail" - end of chapter.

- What might be similar about Native American children and your life, and what is different?

→ VIEW

1. Look at the pictures of the various dwellings of the tribes. How are their homes different from one another?
2. Look at the children on p.54 and p.56 when they arrived at the boarding schools and then a year or so later on p.55 and p.57. What are the differences? Why do you think the government wanted to put Indian children in these schools? What do you think the children and parents thought about it?
3. (Optional) This video tells about the Trail of Tears, when 60,000 Native Americans were forced to relocate to a reservation.
∞ Video Link: Trail of Tears (3:00)

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32

An Array of Gifts

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How do you feel when people give you gifts? Perry thought he would try to win over the Japanese by giving them all kinds of gifts that would represent America.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.78-86

- Which gift of the Americans do you think was the most interesting?
- Which gift of the Japanese do you think was the most interesting?

→ VIEW

1. If you are interested, look at the list of gifts in Appendix C & D, p.127-130.
2. The Japanese gave the Americans pieces of lacquerware. Lacquer, a shiny, hard surface, is applied to materials such as wood or metal. Then pictures are painted on the objects.
∞ Image Link: Writing lacquer box

• EXTRA HELPING

One of the gifts the Americans brought to Japan was a telegraph. Watch this short video to learn about this invention.

∞ Video Link: The Telegraph

WEEK 9 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33

Frontier Schools

📄 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

If you were a teacher at a one-room schoolhouse with students ranging in age from seven to sixteen, what subjects would you teach, and how would you go about teaching and managing a classroom in that kind of environment?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.59-69 "I remember the" - "to be trouble."

- What stands out to you about the frontier schools? How would you solve some of the issues they had to deal with?

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ VIEW

Look at the images in this chapter and talk about what was different about schooling back then.

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33

The Grand Banquet, The Treaty

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-96 "Before going back"- "enjoy their company."

- Are you surprised by the concessions the Japanese made in the treaty?
- Why do you think they were now open to engaging with foreigners?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview content on p.91 that talks about a minstrel show.

• DEFINITIONS

diplomacy: the work of maintaining good relations between the governments of different countries (p.87)

WEEK 10 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34

Building the West

Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

What kind of chores do you have around your house? You will read about the chores that frontier children were responsible for since they had no modern conveniences.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-81 "At a frontier" - "any gold miner."

- What chores do you think you would have enjoyed if you lived in those days? Which ones would you have disliked?
- Why do you think variety shows and circuses were a popular thing at that time?

→ VIEW

Look at the photographs in this chapter and talk about the various chores and jobs.

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34

Excursions on Land and Sea, Shore Leave

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Shimoda, Japan

1. You will see that Shimoda is darkened on this map. This is one of the ports that the Americans are allowed to use. This is also the fishing village that was mentioned at the beginning of the book that first sighted the 4 black ships.

∞ Map Link: Hakodate, Japan

2. Hakodate is circled on the map. Where is it located in relation to Shimoda? This is the other port city that the Americans were allowed to go to.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.97-106 "After the treaty"- "ever heard of."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview bottom of p.98 and top of p.99, which again mention ritual suicide. P.102 talks about a bathhouse that is shared by both men and women.

• DEFINITIONS

daguerreotype: an early photograph produced on a silver or a silver-covered copper plate (p.103)

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

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Term 3

- What were some of the differences between the American customs and lifestyle and the Japanese?

WEEK 11 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35

Games, Parties, and Celebrations

 Materials: Children of the Wild West

→ INTRO

Life on the frontier wasn't all work. There was time for play and fun! You may be surprised to read about all the activities and celebrations that were part of the children's lives.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-94 "When pioneer children" - "filled with patriotism?"

- If you could ask pioneer children any questions about their lives, what would you ask them?
- If someone took a photo of you to put in a book for students to read in 100 years or so to see what life was like in 2026, what would you do in the photo?

- **ILLUSTRATE** - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35

In the Wake of the Black Ships, Afterward

 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The United States has consuls all over the world. Consuls are representatives of a government who reside in a foreign country to assist and protect citizens of the consul's country and to promote and facilitate relations between the two countries. Two years after Perry, it was time to send a consul to Japan. Let's see if he is welcomed.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16, Afterward

- Why do you think other people were so interested in going to Japan now that it was open to foreigners?
- What were the positive changes that took place in Japan once they ended the feudal system?

• DEFINITIONS

pantaloons: loose-fitting, usually shorter than ankle-length pants (p.107)

WEEK 12 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Children of the Wild West

WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun